The Care Reassessment Preparation Checklist

What to write down, ask and keep track of while Dad is managing at home.

Dad manages at home with a little help, and nothing has gone wrong. That makes today's picture an easy one to put on paper. Take these in any order, with no date to finish by. Check what you've done. Anything unchecked is something not yet written down or asked, and that is all it is.

Write down

- [ ] The tasks in an ordinary week for Dad, with the ones he does entirely himself left on the list.
- [ ] Where he gets a hand, with what, and from whom: the Saturday groceries, the pill box, the ride to the eye doctor. [1]
- [ ] How often each bit of help happens, only where you know it or someone has confirmed it. Elsewhere, write “not recorded.”
- [ ] How he gets around, indoors and out, and what helps him hear, see and keep in touch, written as what you've seen.
- [ ] What each person who helps can realistically keep doing, in their own words. [1]
- [ ] The date, and who wrote the page.

Ask

- [ ] Ask Dad to read the page and correct it. He'll know where you got his week wrong. [2]
- [ ] Ask the people who know his health, at a routine visit: which changes would you want to hear about from us?
- [ ] Ask whether there is any kind of help they consider necessary for him now, and note who said it and when.
- [ ] Ask who would take a fresh look at what Dad needs if something changed, and how a family requests that.

Keep track of

- [ ] The list of needs and open questions from the earlier step, if you made one. Keep it with this page.
- [ ] Questions about whether Dad should have someone with him or checking in at certain times, kept as questions for the people who assess him.
- [ ] What matters about the help he gets, in two short lists: essentials and preferences. Use Dad's words where you have them.
- [ ] The kinds of help or services you'd want to learn about if things changed, written as questions, not choices.

What this checklist doesn't do

It helps you write down, ask and keep track. It doesn't say which changes matter, whether Dad's help will ever need to change, or what kind of help that would be. A page with every box checked is still a record of today. What a change would mean is for the people who assess him, and for the next step below.

Ready for the next step?

You've put today's help on paper and lined up what to ask. The care interview asks about every area of Dad's daily life, including the ones that are fine right now, so the record isn't assembled from memory, and turns your answers into a Family Care Profile you can bring to any care conversation.

Create Your Free Family Care Profile ›

WHERE THIS COMES FROM

Items marked 1 follow the questions the Family Caregiver Alliance suggests families answer on paper: what help the person needs now, and what help family members can give. The item marked 2 follows the National Institute on Aging's advice to ask the person directly. The rest come from the Family Care Roadmap's own working list for this step.

1. Family Caregiver Alliance, Caregiving at Home: A Guide to Community Resources
2. National Institute on Aging, Does an Older Adult in Your Life Need Help?